Sofia's Practice Toolkit

The 15-week plan to the Winter Showcase · Sep 28 → Sat Jan 9, 2027

Glass House Dance · Team PITCH
Solo · Trio · 2026–27

Four parts, one goal

Each part has a different job. Don't skip ahead. Ms. Brittany: **memorize first, then improve the moves and tricks.**

1
Own it
Weeks 1–6 · Sep 28–Nov 8

Know every step with **no video and no one to follow**. Solo: Hannah's two videos, step by step. Knees over toes.

2
Clean it
Weeks 7–9 · Nov 9–Nov 29

Feet, knees, arms, eyes. **One fix a week.** Trick preps look like dancing. Thanksgiving week is light.

3
Perform it
Weeks 10–14 · Nov 30–Jan 3

Focal points, stamina, **full-out runs**, costume on. Hold every ending.

4
Taper
Week 15 · Jan 4–9

One run a day. Nothing new. No deep stretching. Sleep. **Show Sat Jan 9!**

Big checkpoints

Sat Oct 31	Whole **trio**, no video, nobody marking	☐
Sun Nov 1	Whole **solo** from memory, on the music	☐
Next solo rehearsal	Show Ms. Brittany: no missed steps	☐
Sun Nov 29	Every solo fix checked on page 4	☐
Dec 14 week	Solo in costume (twice in Dec)	☐
Sat Jan 2	Mandatory rehearsal: back from break!	☐
Thu Jan 7	Mini show for the family	☐
Sat Jan 9	**Winter Showcase ★**	☐

My week

Mon	Ballet · Acro · Jazz Tech at the studio. **Rest at home.**
Tue	Hip Hop · Ballroom. **Rest at home.**
Wed	Contemporary · solo rehearsal with Ms. Brittany when booked
Thu	HOME: strong + bendy + trio section + solo
Fri	HOME: technique + this week's trick + solo
Sat	Co Tech · PITCH rehearsal
Sun	HOME: FILM the solo + trio section + film review

Trio privates with Larisa 1–2× a month. Home sessions are 30–40 minutes.

After the Showcase

Press Play Jan 15–17 (classes only) → Hollywood Connection Jan 22–24 → Ryze Feb 19–21 → iD Feb 26–28 → Gravit8 Mar 12–14 → Hollywood Vibe Apr 30–May 2 → Showstopper May 14–16 → Glass House Ball Jun 19–20. Then the plan restarts: own it, clean it, perform it, in shorter loops between comps.

Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

My 15-week tracker

Check a box for every home practice. Sunday: write your ONE fix for next week.

Thu · Fri · Sun
F = filmed

WK	WEEK OF	SOLO GOAL	TRIO GOAL	FRI TRICK	THU	FRI	SUN	F	MY ONE FIX
1 · OWN IT									
1	Sep 28	0:00–0:48 from memory	0:00–0:22 opening + floor phrase	1 Side-sit reach	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2	Oct 5	0:48–2:00 from memory	0:22–0:42 stillness → crawl	2 Side extension	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3	Oct 12	**Hannah video 1**, step by step	0:42–1:04 CANON: know my count	Memory + knees	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4	Oct 19	**Hannah video 2**, step by step	1:04–2:17 runs → bridges → end	Memory + knees	☐	☐	☐	☐	
1 · OWN IT (continued) · Ms. Brittany's homework									
5	Oct 26	**Whole solo from memory**, on the counts	**Whole trio, no video by Sat**	Memory + knees	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6	Nov 2	Whole solo ×2, no stops · show Ms. B	0:22 stillness: one shared focus	Knees over toes	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2 · CLEAN IT									
7	Nov 9	Floor work: point + straighten · side leg: pick one	0:30 arabesque on knees: height + lock	1 Side-sit reach	☐	☐	☐	☐	
8	Nov 16	Long arms · high passé · trick preps are dancing	0:52–0:58 wait in a SHAPE · 0:58 arms	6 Passé turns	☐	☐	☐	☐	
9	Nov 23 · light	One easy run	Say the counts out loud	Rest	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3 · PERFORM IT									
10	Nov 30	Donut roll · a focal point for every section	Dance BIGGER when upstage	8 Donut roll	☐	☐	☐	☐	
11	Dec 7	Two full-outs back to back (Sun)	Whole trio with music ×2	3 Cartwheel · 4 Walkover	☐	☐	☐	☐	
12	Dec 14 · costume	Full run IN costume	Match Lauren's size	5 Floor kick	☐	☐	☐	☐	
13	Dec 21	Hold the ending to 2:00	Hold last picture past 2:12	7 The ending	☐	☐	☐	☐	
14	Dec 28	Costume run #2 · show face on	Whole trio · ready for Sat Jan 2	My weakest	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4 · TAPER									
15	Jan 4	One run a day · mini show Thu	One run (if with the girls)	Nothing new	☐	☐	☐	☐	**SHOW SAT JAN 9 ★**

Sticker rule

One sticker for every home practice. 3 in a week = **full week ★**. At each checkpoint on page 1, pick a reward with Mom (a movie night, a new scrunchie, choosing Saturday breakfast).

Teachers win

If Ms. Brittany, Larisa or Hannah gives a new correction, it becomes **this week's fix** instead of the one on this page.

How to practice at home

The best way to get better between classes: short, often, one thing at a time

For Sofia
and her grown-up

The 35-minute session

5 min	**Warm up.** Jumping jacks, arm circles, leg swings, light jog. Always first.
8 min	**Strong.** Hollow hold + superman 3×20s · plank + side plank 2×20–30s · slow relevés 2×15 · one-leg balance 20s · lying leg lifts 2×10.
7 min	**Bendy**, after warm-up only. Right, left, middle split + straddle, 20–30s each. A stretch, never pain.
5 min	**Knees + technique.** Pliés in 1st and 2nd facing the mirror 2×8, knees over toes. Slow lunges 2×5 each side. Relevés. Tricks wait until the solo is memorized.
10 min	**The dances.** Trio: this week's section (page 5). Solo: mark once, then full out once, eyes up.

Mon and Tue are rest days at home. Solo rehearsals are booked as needed. On a rehearsal or make-up class day, do a short 15-minute memory run instead of the full session.

Learn it so it sticks

1. **One chunk.** Solo: use **Hannah's two videos**. Watch one 8-count, pause, do it, then go on to the next 8.
2. **Slow.** Do it at half speed 3×. The app practice player can slow the music to 75%.
3. **Music.** Do it with the real music.
4. **No help.** Turn away from the video and the mirror. Do it alone.
5. **Say it.** Say the move names out loud while you mark. Words are a second memory.
6. **Chain it.** Add the chunk to the one before it, then run both.
7. **Pause-and-predict.** Mom pauses the video anywhere. Sofia says and shows what comes next. When she never has to guess, the step is learned.
8. **From the top.** Every session: start at the beginning, go as far as you know, then add ONE new chunk.

Set up a dance spot

- ☐ Clear space, with the mat out for anything upside down
- ☐ Tape an **X** on the floor for "center front"
- ☐ A sticker on the wall = **the judges**. Dance to it.
- ☐ Phone on a stand at the **side** for filming
- ☐ Music ready on the app: the real track for each dance
- ☐ Water bottle, hair up, socks off for floor work

Grown-up's job

- **Be the stage crew**, not the teacher: music, timer, filming, stickers.
- Ask, don't correct: "What comes next?" "Where do your eyes go?" "Which fix are you working on?"
- Keep corrections to what the teachers gave. If something looks off, write it under *Questions for my teachers*.
- Praise the work: "You kept your eyes up the whole time," not "you're so talented."
- Start at the same time each practice day. A routine beats willpower.

Brain practice (counts!)

At bedtime, lie still and play one dance's song. **Picture yourself** doing every move in time, with your eyes on your focal points. It's great for memory, and it works on rest days too.

Safety rules

- Warm up before stretching. No oversplits, no forcing.
- Acro only on the mat or with a spotter. Kick-overs and aerials only in class.
- If it hurts, stop and tell a grown-up.
- Stop before tired. Tired teaches the wrong way.

★ Solo · Stay a Little Longer

Lyrical · choreography Hannah · rehearsals with Ms. Brittany when booked · 2:04 track

Soft 0:00–0:48
Full 0:48–1:52 · fade

Where the moves land · checked Oct 25 · photos on the cue cards

START	MOVE	I LOOK AT...
0:00	Opening walk, tendus, arm reach	
0:07	Drop to the floor, sit	
0:10.5	**★ Side-sit leg reach**	
0:12.5	Slide out long, curl, kneeling arms	
0:16.5	**★ Kneeling arch, tip onto hands, leg kicks up**	
0:19.5	Side roll, long stretch	
0:22	Rise, travel, arms up	
0:31.5	**★ Heel stretch, leg held high**	
0:34	Deep lunge · hands behind head · run, kicks	
0:43.75	Gather: fold, V arms, run-up	
0:48	**★ LEAP on the swell**	
0:49.5	**★ Cartwheel**	
0:52	High kick, turns, lunges, arms	
1:07.75	**★ Walkover to knees** (handstand, bridge, knees)	
1:10.5	Kneeling arms, kneeling leg kick	
1:17	Run to the mat	
1:18.25	**★ Donut roll on the mat**	
1:21	Traveling, passé on the mat	
1:28.5	**★ Handstand**, split legs, step down to sit	
1:30.5	Floor section, straddle at 1:38	
1:40.75	**★ Floor kick**	
1:42.5	Rise, turn + kick, drop, lunge up	
1:49.5	**★ Passé turns**, arms overhead	
1:53	V arms, lower to sit	
1:57.5	Seated leg lift	
2:00.5	**★ Floor ending**: curl on your side, hold	

My fixes · check when the teacher says "yes"

- ☐ **Knees over toes** in every plié, lunge, landing and floor entry. No knees falling in. *(Ms. Brittany, Oct 13)*
- ☐ **Point + straighten** on every floor extension, even as the leg comes down
- ☐ **Side leg: pick one.** A clean attitude or straight. Never halfway.
- ☐ **Eyes up.** No mirror, no teacher. Every section has a spot.
- ☐ **Long arms.** Elbows straight overhead, shoulders down.
- ☐ **Passé high.** Toe beside the knee, high relevé, sharp spot.
- ☐ **Trick prep is dancing.** Head stays up until the hands go down.
- ☐ **Donut roll:** chin tucked, over the shoulder, chest leads.
- ☐ **Hold the ending** until 2:00, when the sound is gone.

Trick ladder · starts Nov 9, after the solo is memorized

Check **Can do** (alone), **Clean ×3** (3 in a row), **In the dance** (on the beat in a full run).

TRICK	THE DRILL	CAN DO	CLEAN ×3	IN THE DANCE
1 · Side-sit leg reach 0:10.5	Sit on one hip, hand on the floor. Leg straight up: 4 counts up, hold 2, 4 down. 6 each side. Arm slides up the leg. *"Push the floor, reach the toe."*	☐	☐	☐
2 · Heel stretch 0:31.5	Développé side at a counter: 4 up, hold 2, 4 down ×6. Side-lying leg lifts 2×12. Standing heel down.	☐	☐	☐
3 · Leap + cartwheel 0:48 · 0:49.5	Leap ON the swell, then cartwheel: reach, look, place. Cartwheel over a tape line, legs straight. Play from 0:44 ×5.	☐	☐	☐
4 · Walkover to knees 1:07.75 + handstand 1:28.5	Wrists first. Wall handstand 3×10–15s. Kick up to vertical ×5, split at the top ×5. Kick-overs only with a spotter.	☐	☐	☐
5 · Floor kick 1:40.75	8 slow kicks each side, 4 up, 4 down, pointed at the top. Kick from the hip, back long.	☐	☐	☐
6 · Passé turns 1:49.5	Passé balance on relevé 10s. Quarter ×8, half ×8, singles ×10. Spot a sticker.	☐	☐	☐
7 · The ending 2:00.5	Last 15 seconds of the real track ×5. Hold, breathe, count 8 more after you think it's over.	☐	☐	☐
8 · Donut roll 1:18.25	Mat only. Cobra + seal 20s first. Kneel, sit back, roll back over ONE SHOULDER (head to the side, chin tucked), up to the knees ×5. Never over the head.	☐	☐	☐

★ Trio · Enjoy the Silence

Contemporary · choreography + teacher Larisa · with Hannah and Lauren · 2:17 slow cover, ~86 BPM

Larisa's rule: memorize first, clean in privates

Memory map

Video → with music → no help. Check a box only when it runs clean **twice**. One section per Thursday and Sunday (see the tracker).

TIME	SECTION	VIDEO	MUSIC	NO HELP ✓✓
0:00	Kneeling opening	☐	☐	☐
0:02	Lunges: back leg long and pointed	☐	☐	☐
0:04	Floor phrase: leg extensions + shoulder stand	☐	☐	☐
0:22	Kneeling STILLNESS: one shared focus	☐	☐	☐
0:28	Low crawl, arabesque on knees, seated extensions	☐	☐	☐
0:42	Rise + traveling CANON: know YOUR start count	☐	☐	☐
1:04	Runs + lunges (Lauren's acro)	☐	☐	☐
1:12	Arms-up phrase → lunges down to the floor	☐	☐	☐
1:36	THREE BRIDGES → lying	☐	☐	☐
1:50	Traveling triangle	☐	☐	☐
2:06	Ending: three-level floor picture, hold past 2:12	☐	☐	☐
WHOLE DANCE: no video, nobody marking · goal Sat Oct 31				☐

Fixes for the privates

- ☐ **Eyes:** no mirror at 0:02. In the 0:22 stillness all three eyelines agree.
- ☐ **Arabesque on knees (0:30):** match the agreed height, lock the knee.
- ☐ **Canon waiting (0:52–0:58):** hold a SHAPE with intent. Never stand "off."
- ☐ **Arms overhead (0:58):** straight, not hands to the head. Match Hannah's line.
- ☐ **Upstage = bigger.** When I'm farthest from the judges, I dance bigger.
- ☐ **Match Lauren's size.** She dances the biggest.

Already strong: shoulder stand (cleanest of the three), lunge at 0:02, bridge at 1:36, full-out runs.

The music won't help, so we do

The song stays almost the same volume until a small lift at 1:32 and fades at 2:12. The **three of you** make the big and small moments with stillness against speed.

Home trick: the canon is the hardest part. Fill in the count sheet below for 0:42–1:04 with Larisa or from the video, then **say your counts out loud** while you mark.

Canon count sheet · 0:42–1:04

Write a move name (or a doodle) in each count box. Star the count where YOU start.

8#	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1								
2								
3								
4								

This week

Week # ____ · Week of _____ · Print a new page every week

Fill in Sunday after the film review

Thursday · strong + bendy + trio

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Strong 8 min
- ☐ Bendy 7 min
- ☐ TRIO section: _____ (video → music → no help)
- ☐ Solo: mark once, full out once

Friday · technique + trick

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Passé balances, pirouettes, kicks
- ☐ Trick: _____ (until Nov 9: knees over toes drills)
- ☐ Solo: full out once, eyes up
- ☐ Brain practice at bedtime

Sunday · film it

- ☐ Warm up 5 min
- ☐ Solo full out, FILMED from the side
- ☐ Send the video to the app Coach
- ☐ TRIO section: _____
- ☐ Light stretch
- ☐ Film review (right) →

Before every run, say it

Point. Straighten. Eyes up. Long arms. Hit the beat. Hold the end.

Sunday film review

Watch once with a grown-up. Then write:

One thing I loved

One fix for next week (only one!)

Best today: ☐ feet ☐ knees ☐ eyes ☐ arms

Did I hold the ending until the music stopped? ☐ yes ☐ not yet

Missed or mixed-up steps? Where: _____

App Coach said: ☐ same as my teacher ☐ something new (ask Ms. Brittany first)

What my teachers said this week

Ms. Brittany · Larisa · Isadora · Hannah. Star Ms. Brittany's top 3.

Questions for my teachers

How I feel about my dances

Solo: hard · okay · good · great **Trio:** hard · okay · good · great

Circle one. A "hard" week is a good week to tell Mom what feels hard.

Trio private with Larisa (if this week)

DATE	WHAT LARISA FIXED	PRACTICE THIS AT HOME